

Westhampton Public Library Board of Trustees

Date: 7.9.24

Time: 6:01pm

Community Room Westhampton Public Library

In-Person and Virtual Meeting

Present: Meaghan Schwelm, Anne Marie O'Reilly, Angela Griefen, Deb Smith - via Zoom, Jackie Brodeur, Alison Thirkield, Sue O'Rourke – representing the Friends of the Library.

Absent:

1. Call To Order @ 6:01pm
2. Minutes from Last meeting: Approved, as corrected
3. Treasurer's Report:
4. Account Balances:
 - Building - \$3,594.48
 - State Aid - \$7,765.10
 - Deferred Town Monies - \$xxx
 - Gifts - \$20,322.48
5. Director's Report
 - A. June Statistics
 - 6 children's programs with 86 attending
 - 21 adult programs with 152 attending
 - 0 teen programs with 0 attending (Emily takes a break before summer reading)
 - 52 volunteer hours
 - Circulations 1,890 (in June 2023 - 1,783)
 - Ebook circulations 480 (in June 2023 - 442)
 - B. Community Room Request and discussion:

It Takes a Village leadership team would like to use the community room on Friday, July 12th during hours when we are closed. We will be using the room to gather donations for the crafter's swap scheduled for Saturday, July 13th, but there are only four people who would be meeting in the room.

Discussion: Meaghan made the Trustees aware that there was a malfunctioning alarm sensor in one of the closets. The Trustees decided that there would be a future discussion of the Community Room Use during times when the Library is closed. The alarm function will also be addressed.
 - C. Accessibility Update and discussion:

We have a revised plan for providing better access to the library yard for programs and have been working with Berkshire Design Group to develop this plan. The plan would include a safe drop-off point on Stage Road, as well as an ADA path, platform and pergola directly off of the ADA parking spaces.

Discussion: The Student Plan for an ADA compliant walkway is complicated due to the grade of the site. Any walkway would require extensive site work, as well as taking a lot of space for the walkway to be built at the correct grade. The current plan would include

building a pergola/deck and a straight walkway from the parking lot to the bench area. This would also create an outdoor area for programming. The only issue raised about this is that it would segregate people using the deck from the main activity area. Meaghan will ask Berkshire Design to refine the plans to include measurements and add a pergola to provide shade for the proposed deck.

D. Accidents in Parking Lot

There have been two incidents of cars parked along the side of the parking lot in unofficial parking spaces being hit by cars backing out from designated parking over the past two months.

Discussion: Could large rocks and or signs address the problem? Jackie will speak to Bill J. at the highway Department to see what's feasible.

6. Friend's Report: Sue O'Rourke attended this meeting. She discussed the Friends annual newsletter, let the Trustees know that donations were arriving from the newsletter appeal, and spoke about the plans for Fall Festival. The annual quilt Raffle is ongoing.
7. Old Business
 - A. Approve minutes of May Meeting: Approved, as corrected
 - B. Reorganization of the Board: Trustees confirmed existing roles for the next year. Anne Marie O'Reilly - Chair, Jackie Brodeur - Treasurer, Deb Estelle – Secretary.
 - C. Continue Work of Library Policy Consolidation: Discussion of Draft revision of "Meeting Rooms Usage Policy and Rules". Revisions were suggested, draft of the policy with the revisions will be reviewed at the September 10th, Trustee Meeting.
 - D. Director's Performance Review: Trustee comments should be submitted to Anne Marie for inclusion in final Review document.
8. New Business
 - A. Strengthening ties with Library Friends: Suggestion for possible rotation of Trustees to Friend's meetings on a quarterly basis. The Trustee could not speak as an official representative of the Trustees in these meetings and the purpose would be for information exchange.
 - B. Warrant Coverage in August: Angela Griefen will cover this.
9. Any other Business to come before the Trustees, not anticipated at the time of posting of this agenda: None.

Meeting Adjourned: 7:30pm

Next Meeting: 9.10.24

Submitted By: Deb Estelle